Tomislav Mesarić

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Butcher and meat counter professional with 9 years' experience in retail butchery and meat-counter service. Skilled in breaking down beef, pork and lamb, boning and trimming, portioning meat to order, and advising customers on cuts and cooking. HACCP knowledge and training, with experience rotating cold-room stock using FIFO, and maintaining clean, safe counters and equipment.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Butcher | Mesnica Kod Ante, Zagreb *2019–Present*

- Break down 2–3 beef forequarters and 10–12 pork sides each week; bone, trim and cut, portion and wrap fresh meat for the service counter.
- Prepare four kinds of fresh sausage; produce around 40 kg weekly in the busy season.
- Developed the shop's lamb merguez recipe and adjusted the ćevapi mix to 70% beef and 30% lamb following customer feedback. The ćevapi won second place at the Zagreb County craft meat fair in 2023.
- Record cold-room (0–4 °C) and display-counter temperature checks twice daily; rotate cold-room stock each morning using FIFO, placing the oldest stock at the front.
- Serve around 120 customers on a Saturday, advising on cuts and cooking times.
- Trained two apprentices in knife handling and cleaning routines.
- Prepared whole lambs and suckling pigs for spit-roasting at weddings and family events, including ordering, butchering, seasoning and delivery. Largest order: four lambs and two pigs for a 180-guest wedding in 2024.
- Kept weight-loss and temperature records during a six-week dry-ageing trial of beef ribs.

Counter Assistant | Tržnica Dolac meat hall stall, Zagreb *2015–2019*

- Served customers, weighed and priced orders, operated the till and completed cash-up.
- Cleaned and sanitised slicers, mincers and the counter at closing.
- Wrote a closing and cleaning checklist covering the slicer, mincer, counter and floor drain.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATES

Vocational Certificate: Butcher (3-year programme) | Food Trades School Zagreb | 2015

HACCP Basic Food Hygiene Certificate | 2021; renewed 2024

Preparing for the Master Butcher exam (majstorski ispit), planned for spring 2027

SKILLS

Carcass breakdown (beef, pork and lamb) · Boning and trimming · Portioning meat to order · Fresh sausage making · Knife sharpening · Mincer and bandsaw operation · FIFO stock rotation · Customer advice on cuts and cooking · Counter cleaning and sanitation · Cash handling

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native) · English (good) · German (basic)